

Can a practicing surgeon detect early lymphedema reliably?

Answer (EN)

The source does not state that a practicing surgeon can reliably detect early lymphedema. It reports that lymphedema “may be identified by simpler circumference changes as compared with changes in limb volume,” and that a 10% volume increase or >1 cm increase in arm circumference identified lymphedema, with verification by a lymphedema specialist (arXiv:SciQ:ctx). Sensitivity and specificity of several criteria were compared using an academic trial as the standard, so reliability was evaluated for the measurement criteria themselves—not for a practicing surgeon (arXiv:SciQ:ctx). No surgeon is mentioned in the paper.

中文速览

论文未说明执业外科医生能否可靠识别早期淋巴水肿。文中仅指出：淋巴水肿可通过臂围/体积改变识别（10% 体积增加或臂围增加 >1cm），并由淋巴水肿专科医生验证；随后比较了各判据的敏感度与特异度。“外科医生”并非该研究的考察对象，故无法据此作答。

Source evidence

“Lymphedema may be identified by simpler circumference changes as compared with changes in limb volume.” and “A 10% volume increase or greater than 1 cm increase in arm circumference identified lymphedema with verification by a lymphedema specialist.”

Final decision: maybe